GRADWRITE '24

PACK XL2

Head Editor:
Kunaal Chandrashekar

Pack Editor:
Adrian O'Leary

Contributors:

Asha Basu	McKenna Gray	Eli Nason	Matthew Stasiw
Charlotte Bauer	Susanna Liao	Adrian O'Leary	Serena Suleman
Kunaal Chandrashekar	Eva Mandelbaum	Nathan O'Leary	Stefan Vlad
James Ferrabee	Simon Mezo	Anna Reso	Chloe Wei

10-Part Blitz

1. Which Greek mathematician was the first to compute the Earth's circumference and names a sieve for finding primes?

A: **Eratosthenes** of Cyrene

2. Shēng, dàn, jìng, and chǒu [cho] are the four main roles in what style of performance, known by a name referring to the city it emerged from?

A: **Peking opera** (accept: **Beijing opera**)

3. Which founder of the Camp Flog Gnaw Carnival music festival wrote the albums *Wolf* and *Igor*?

A: **Tyler the Creator** (accept: Tyler **Okonma**)

4. Name either word in the English dictionary with three consecutive double letters.

A: **bookkeeping** or **bookkeeper** (accept plurals)

5. Throwing a chunk of Ireland into the Irish sea to create the Isle of Man is one of many stories of which Irish mythological hero depicted in the Fenian cycle?

A: Fionn **mac Cumhaill** [finn mac-COOL]

6. In fandom spaces, what does the acronym RPF stand for?

A: **real person fiction** (accept: **real people fiction**)

7. Siblings Violet, Klaus, and Sunny Baudelaire are the subjects of what thirteen-book series by Lemony Snicket?

A: *A **Series of Unfortunate Events***

8. To the nearest billion dollars, how much money in USD was paid by Elon Musk for the acquisition of Twitter?

A: **forty-four** billion dollars

9. What material made from *Quercus suber* shares a name with the Republic of Ireland's second largest city?

A: **cork**

10. What psychologist ran the Small World Experiment and an electric shock-based obedience experiment?

A: Stanley **Milgram**

Set of 4: Nobel Prizes

11. Lester Pearson was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for his work resolving what conflict?

A: **Suez Crisis** (accept: **Second Arab-Israeli War**)

12. Who decided to decline the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1964 saying that he did not want to be "institutionalized"?

A: Jean-Paul **Sartre**

13. Sveriges Riksbank established which Nobel Memorial Prize in 1968, the only of the six not to have been established in Alfred Nobel's will?

A: Sveriges Riksbank Prize in **Economic** Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel
(accept: The Nobel Memorial Prize in **Economic** Sciences)
(accept: **Nobel Prize in Economic** Sciences)

14. Which University of Waterloo professor won the Nobel Prize in Physics in 2019 for her work with chirped pulse amplification?

A: Donna **Strickland**

Pyramid – What am I?

15. **Clue A:** Iodides of lead and me were used to extend the monsoon season during the Vietnam War, creating a tactical advantage for the US. What am I?
Clue B: I am the best conductor of heat and electricity of any known elemental metal, and I am commonly used in soldering. What am I?
Clue C: Some of my neighbours on the periodic table include cadmium to my right and palladium to my left. What am I?
Clue D: I have atomic number 47 and am traditionally used in medals for athletes who finish in second place. What am I?

A: **silver** (accept: **Ag**)

Set of 4: Fraudsters

16. What Italian-born fraudster was convicted in 1920 for eighty-six counts of mail fraud due to the lies he told to investors?

A: Charles **Ponzi**

17. Han van Meegeren was famous for his forgeries of what Dutch master, including a version of *The Last Supper* which drew on this artist's *Girl with a Pearl Earring*?

A: Johannes **Vermeer**

18. What role, with abilities such as extended vision and using vents, encourages players to pretend to be a crewmate in *Among Us*?

A: **Imposter**

19. A 419 scam is another name for what type of phishing attack that promises a large amount of money if a smaller sum is sent?

A: **Nigerian Prince** scam (prompt on: **advance-fee** scam, any kind of royal person scam)

Double Jump

20. The return of Rama to Ayodhya [eye-OH-dee-uh] is one possible inspiration for what Hindu festival of lights?

A: **Diwali** (accept: **Deepavali**)

21. In the Ramayana, Rama returns home after defeating what ten-headed demon king of Lanka?

A: **Ravan**a

Double Jump

22. Which 2001 movie, based on a book series by Meg Cabot, follows teenager Mia Thermopolis discovering she is heir-apparent to a European principality?

A: *The **Princess Diaries***

23. What is the name of the fictional European principality in *The Princess Diaries*, home of the Renaldi royal family, and said to be located somewhere between France and Italy?

A: **Genovia**

Mystery Link

24. A secret agent named Sterling is the main character of what Adam Reed animated adult sitcom?

A: ***Archer***

25. A supernova reported by Chinese astronomers in 1054 formed what nebula?

A: **Crab** nebula

26. In contrast to the serial kind which must be accessed in a specific order, rapid storage and retrieval is allowed by what kind of computer memory?

A: **RAM** (accept: **random access memory**, but reveal **RAM**)

27. Arturo di Modica made a sculpture of what animal, an icon of New York City's financial district?

A: **bull**

28. What anatomical element of a fish fits the category?

A: **scales**

All are western zodiac signs.

10-Part Blitz

29. Jomon, Yayoi, and Kofun were early periods in the history of what country?

A: **Japan** (accept: **Nippon**, **Nihon**)

30. What is the largest American metropolitan area not to feature an NFL team?

A: **San Antonio**

31. Historically, what did A/S/L [A slash S slash L] mean on online chatrooms?

A: **age, sex, location**

32. One watt-hour is equal to how many joules?

A: **3,600**

33. Although Chris Pratt portrayed Mario in the most recent movie, what voice actor has portrayed him in almost every other appearance until *Super Mario Bros. Wonder*?

A: Charles **Martinet**

34. After Aconcagua, what is the second highest mountain in South America, with a name possibly meaning "Salty Eyes"?

A: **Ojos del Salado**

35. The sunrise problem is used as an example of which reasoning method, contrasted with deduction?

A: **induction** (accept word forms)

36. What is the name for the fear of nudity?

A: **gymnophobia**

37. Which Ethiopian-Eritrean conflict finally ended after two years in November 2022 with the Ethiopian government and rebel forces signing a cessation agreement?

A: **Tigray War**

38. Released on March 22nd, *Las Mujeres Ya No Lloran* is the most recent album of what "Queen of Latin Music"?

A: **Shakira** Isabel Mebarak Ripoll

END OF FIRST QUARTER

SECOND QUARTER

Splits: World Capitals Wordplay and Literary Duos

World Capitals Wordplay

39. Which African archipelago capital city becomes an anagram for the capital of Samoa when an 'r' is removed?

A: **Praia** (becomes Apia)

40. Which western African capital city becomes an anagram for the capital of South Sudan when an 'a' is removed?

A: **Abuja** (becomes Juba)

41. Which central Asian capital city becomes an anagram for the capital city with the lowest elevation when an 'l' is removed?

A: **Kabul** (becomes Baku)

42. What Middle Eastern capital city becomes an anagram for a capital formerly known as Nur-Sultan when a "t" is added?

A: **Sanaa** (becomes Astana)

Literary Duos

43. In what play do Pozzo and Lucky meet Vladimir and Estragon, a work of absurdist theater by Samuel Beckett?

A: ***Waiting for Godot*** (accept: ***En Attendant Godot***)

44. What surname is shared by a Victorian poet couple, one of whom wrote the dramatic monologue "My Last Duchess" and the other of whom wrote Sonnets from the Portuguese?

A: **Browning**

45. Eventually revealed to be the same person, which duo titles a Stevenson novel in which a reputable doctor has an evil alter ego?

A: Dr. Henry **Jekyll** and Mr. Edward **Hyde** (do not prompt on partial answers)

46. Which duo titles a text used in linguistics to demonstrate the phonetics of a language, one of Aesop's fables about how persuasion is better than force?

A: the **North Wind** and the **Sun** (prompt on: **Wind** and **Sun**)

Set of 4: Alloys

47. Free electrons that are shared between all ions categorize what type of bonds that hold together alloys?
    A: **metallic** bonds
48. An amalgam is an alloy of which element with any other metal?
    A: **mercury** (accept: **Hg**)
49. Which two elements are found alongside aluminum in AlNiCo?
    A: **nickel** and **cobalt** (accept either order)
50. What type of alloy is created by the atoms of a smaller metal filling the spaces between the atoms of a larger metal?
    A: **interstitial** alloy

Pyramid – What three letters am I?
This pyramid will ask for three letters, which you may give in any order and which may be clued up in any order. Partial answers will not be prompted.

51. **Clue A:** I form an acronym for a finance product which features prominently in the film *The Big Short* and was a primary reason for the 2008 financial crisis. What three letters am I?
    Clue B: I form a common acronym for a video game which has maps such as Resistance, Summit, and Shipment. What three letters am I?
    Clue C: I form the name for the only member of the seven dwarves who isn't named for an adjective. What three letters am I?
    Clue D: I form an acronym for a common mental health disorder who's symptoms may include the repetition of time consuming tasks. What three letters am I?
    A: **DOC** (accept: **DCO**, **OCD**, **ODC**, **CDO**, **COD**; pronunciations or letter-by-letter readings are acceptable)

Set of 3: Shape Areas
Give exact simplified answers.

52. What is the area of an equilateral triangle with side length 2?
    A: square **root** of **3**

53. What is the area of a rhombus with side length 2 and acute angle 60 degrees?

A: **2** times the square **root** of **3**

54. What is the area of a regular hexagon with side length 2?

A: **6** times the square **root** of **3**

Set of 4: Oman

55. At its height, Oman conquered and controlled what strategic opening in the Persian Gulf?

A: **Strait of Hormuz** (prompt on partial answers)

56. In "History of the Entire World, I Guess," Bill Wurtz stated that the Sultan of Oman lives on what Tanzanian island, which was indeed controlled by an offshoot of the Omani royal family until the 1960s?

A: **Zanzibar**

57. Oman has the largest population of which Islam denomination?

A: **Ibadi** (accept: **Ibadism**)

58. Oman asserted its influence in the Western Indian Ocean by defeating what European power?

A: **Portugal**

Double Jump

59. What international chain founded by Ingvar Kamprad is famous for their meatballs and DIY furniture?

A: **IKEA**

60. What Swedish word translating to "jungle forest" names a set of stuffed animals sold by IKEA, including most notably a large brown bear?

A: **djungelskog**

Double Jump

61. Who featured challenging chord changes on the saxophone on his album *Giant Steps*?

A: **John Coltrane**

62. What other saxophonist, who had a friendly rivalry with Coltrane, appeared alongside him in *Tenor Madness* and recorded *Saxophone Colossus*?

A: **Sonny Rollins**

Streak

63. Name up to all countries in which commercial whaling operations are still considered legal.

A: **Norway**
Iceland
Japan (accept: **Nippon**, **Nihon**)

Streak

64. Name up to all six of the students of Master Wu who composed the Secret Ninja Force in the Lego Ninjago Movie.

A: **Cole**
Jay
Zane
Kai
Lloyd Garmadon (do not prompt on or accept: **Garmadon**)
Nya

Streak

65. Spell up to all three homophones of the word "bald".

A: **B-A-L-L-E-D**
B-A-W-L-E-D
B-A-L-D

Linked Set of 8

66. What animal has the most teeth in the animal kingdom, arranged on radulae in their mouth?

A: **snail**

67. What is the name of Spongebob Squarepants's pet sea snail?

A: **Gary**

68. What U.S. state is home to the largest U.S. city named Gary, located southeast of Chicago?

A: **Indiana**

69. What actor is notable for playing the title character of the Indiana Jones film franchise?

A: Harrison **Ford**

70. Which governor of New York later served as the vice president of Gerald Ford?

A: Nelson **Rockefeller**

71. What shellfish can be prepared in a style known as Rockefeller, but can also be eaten raw "on the half-shell" after shucking?

A: **oyster**

72. What city's public transit system can be paid for using an Oyster Card?

A: **London**, England

73. What is the four-letter name of the canine protagonist of Jack London's *The Call of the Wild*?

A: **Buck**

END OF FIRST HALF

THIRD QUARTER

Splits: Latin American Revolutions and Evolutionary Biology

Latin American Revolutions

74. Profiled in *The Black Jacobins*, what revolution ended with Jean-Jacques Dessalines ruling the namesake country?

A: **Haitian** Revolution

75. Given the nickname "the Liberator," which South American revolutionary names the currency of Venezuela?

A: Simón **Bolívar**

76. Félix was the nephew of what Mexican dictator, whose overthrow marked the start of the Mexican revolution?

A: Porfirío **Diaz**

77. Which leader of the 26th of July Movement was succeeded by his brother following his declining health in 2008?

A: **Fidel Castro** (prompt on: **Castro**) (do not accept other Castros)

Evolutionary Biology

78. What five-letter synonym for a monophyletic group includes an organism and all of its descendents?

A: **clade**

79. Which English mathematical biologist names a principle that explains why the ratio of males to females is approximately one for sexually reproducing species?

A: Sir Ronald Aylmer **Fisher**

80. Predator-prey and host-parasite interactions can result in what kind of coevolution, named for a similar geopolitical phenomenon?

A: coevolutionary **arms race** (accept: evolutionary **arms race**)

81. A famous example of natural selection is the change in the colour of the peppered kind of what insect due to selective pressures caused by soot produced during the Industrial Revolution?

A: peppered **moth**

Set of 3: 2023 World Cups

82. The 2023 Rugby World Cup was held in what European country, a rising rugby power?

A **France**

83. Led by captain Pat Cummins, which country won the 2023 Cricket World Cup?

A: **Australia**

84. Who came second in the 2023 Chess World Cup at 18, becoming the youngest player to do so?

A: Rameshbabu **Praggnanandhaa** (accept: **Prag**)

Set of 4: Voting

85. Which economist showed that five important properties, including non-dictatorship, cannot be simultaneously satisfied by any voting system in a namesake impossibility theorem?

A: Kenneth Joseph **Arrow**

86. What synonym for shunning comes from the Athenian practice of voting to expel people from the city for a decade?

A: **ostracism** (accept word forms)

87. "Cracking" and "packing" are two techniques used in what process named for a former Governor of Massachusetts that involves unfair redistricting?

A: **gerrymandering**

88. In the 2021 Canadian federal election, how many seats would a party have needed to win to form a majority in the House of Commons?

A: **170**

Double Jump

89 What Edgar Wright film set in Toronto revolves around the title character fighting the 7 evil exes of Ramona Flowers?

A: ***Scott Pilgrim vs. The World*** (do not prompt on or accept partial answers)

90. What 2023 animated series inspired by the Scott Pilgrim graphic novels brings back the entire main cast of Scott Pilgrim vs. The World as voice actors?

A: ***Scott Pilgrim Takes Off*** (do not prompt on or accept partial answers)

Double Jump

91. The Cassini-Huygens mission primarily studied what planet, which has the most moons of any planet in our solar system?

A: **Saturn**

92. The Cassini probe analyzed the plumes emitted by the spectacular cryovolcanoes of what sixth-largest moon of Saturn?

A: **Enceladus**

Set of 3: Spanish Language Literature

93. Which infinite hexagonal building contains every possible 410-page book in a short story by Jorge Luis Borges?

A: **Library of Babel** (do not accept or prompt on partial answers)

94. Octavio Paz's poem Sunstone is inspired by a stone calendar created by what civilization?

A: **Aztec**

95. What author wrote about Esteban and Alba in her work *The House of the Spirits*?

A: Isabel **Allende**

Jailbreak

96. The Three Gorges dam is located upon which Asian river, also the longest in China?

A: **Yangtze** River (accept: **chang jiang**)

97. A sodium-potassium pump obtains energy by hydrolyzing what molecule, the energy currency of the cell?

A: **ATP** (accept: **adenosine triphosphate**)

98. Which first of the ten Sikh gurus founded Sikhism?

A: Gurū **Nānak** (accept: Bāba **Nānak**)

99. What footwear is worn by the actors in the musical *Starlight Express*?

A: **roller skates** (prompt on: **skates**)

100. What playwright wrote about the Tyrone family in *Long Day's Journey into Night*?

A: Eugene Gladstone **O'Neill**

101. Harun al-Rashid gave a wonderful water-controlled type of what device to Charlemagne in 807 AD?

A: water **clock**

102. What British Crown Dependency is home to the oldest continuous parliament in the world, the Tynwald [tin-wuhld], which meets in its capital of Douglas?

A: **Isle of Man**

103. Which Brazilian-Swedish Orlando Pride forward is often considered the greatest female soccer player of all time?

A: **Marta** Viera da Silva (prompt on: **Viera da Silva**)

104. How would you spell a word meaning to give an incorrect spelling of a word, misspell?

A: **M-I-S-S-P-E-L-L**

105. The Bosphorus Strait connects the Sea of Marmara to what other sea?

A: **Black** Sea

106. What Vancouver-based clothing company is known for their athleisure wear, and was originally founded to sell yoga pants?

A: **Lululemon** Athletica

107. What Dorothea Lange photograph from the Great Depression features the title subject and her three children?

A: ***Migrant Mother***

108. What semi-solid layer of the mantle is the location of the convection currents that drive plate tectonics, and is located just below the lithosphere?

A: **asthenosphere**

109. What M-word refers to the meat of an adult sheep?

A: **mutton**

110. Controversial due to his Nazi ties, which student of Edmund Husserl wrote *Being and Time*?

A: Martin **Heidegger**

111. What letter can be added to a noun describing the causative agent of mad cow disease to get a noun describing the Panopticon?

A: **s** (prion to prison)

112. What group of monomers can be joined together by peptide bonds to form proteins?

A: **amino acids**

113. Who is given the nickname Tepes in Romanian, which like his nickname in English, refers to his preferred method of execution?

A: **Vlad the Impaler** (accept: **Vlad Dracula**, **Vlad III**) (prompt on: **Vlad** Tepes)

END OF THIRD QUARTER

FOURTH QUARTER

Splits: The 2024 Oscars and Musical Instruments Around the World

The 2024 Oscars

114. Best production design, best makeup and hair styling, and best actress were all won by people working on what Yorgos Lanthimos film?

A: ***Poor Things***

115. What ex-WWE star announced the nominees for best costume design while fully naked?

A: John **Cena**

116. Who directed the best animated feature winner *The Boy and the Heron*?

A: Hayao **Miyazaki**

117. *The Zone of Interest* won what award which had previously been won by films such as *All Quiet on the Western Front* and *Parasite*?

A: **Best International Feature Film**

Musical Instruments Around the World

118. Often performing alongside Wayang shadow puppetry, what ensemble that can include gongs, drums, and gangsa is played primarily in Indonesia?

A: **Gamelan**

119. "Horse Racing" is a classic piece of the repertoire of what two-stringed, bowed, Chinese instrument?

A: **erhu**

120. What is the English name given to the West African instrument played with a crooked mallet, a name deriving from its ability to be quickly tuned to mimic human speech?

A: **talking drum**

121. What instrument, with a name that comes from the Persian for "three-stringed", was popularized in the west by Ravi Shankar?

A: **sitar**

Pyramid – What city am I?

122. **Clue A:** Musquodoboit [MUS-ke-DOB-it] is a community in a municipality bearing my name, and I feature the Angus L. Macdonald and A. Murray MacKay bridges. What city am I?
Clue B: The Wanderers and Mooseheads are sports teams in me, and I feature a citadel in my downtown that is a national historic site. What city am I?
Clue C: Robert Stanfield names my international airport, which is located near Shubenacadie. What city am I?
Clue D: Dartmouth and Bedford are communities near me, and I am by far the largest city in Nova Scotia and all of Atlantic Canada. What city am I?
A: **Halifax**

Set of 4: Card Games

123. Hanafuda playing cards were the earliest product of what video game company?
A: **Nintendo**
124. "Bum," "Vice Bum," and the title position are assigned to players in what card game?
A: ***President***
125. In what shedding card game, among the most popular in China, do players get rid of their cards by placing down groups in accordance with the last play such as pair, airplanes, and rockets?
A: ***Dou Dizhu***
126. What rank names a card game that originally used the cards leftover from euchre, following "Crazy" in the name of the game?
A: **eight**

Streak

127. Name up to all six actors who portrayed one of the title characters on the NBC sitcom *Friends*.

A: Jennifer **Aniston**
David **Schwimmer**
Matthew **Perry**
Courteney **Cox**
Lisa **Kudrow**
Matt **LeBlanc**

Streak

128. Name up to all of the last four imperial dynasties of China.

A: Southern **Song** (do not accept: **Northern Song**)
Yuan
Ming
Qing

20-Part Blitz

129. What astronaut collaborated with the Barenaked Ladies for the song "I.S.S. (Is Somebody Singing)"?

A: Chris **Hadfield**

130. What state is home to Amtrack's Keystone Service, which runs from its capital of Harrisburg to Philadelphia?

A: **Pennsylvania**

131. What Italian composer is known for pioneering the opera genre with works such as “L'Arianna”, and “L'Orfeo”?

A: Claudio Giovanni Antonio **Monteverdi**

132. What three-word slogan is used by Skittles?

A: **Taste the Rainbow**

133. March 7, 2024 saw which country become the most recent addition to NATO?

A: **Sweden**

134. What element's nucleus is emitted as the namesake particle of alpha decay?

A: **helium** (accept: **He**)

135. After the death of King Henry VIII, Catherine Parr married Thomas, the brother of which other of Henry's wives?

A: Jane **Seymour**

136. Which two-way player caused heartbreak among Blue Jays fans when he signed with the LA Dodgers in the largest contract in professional sports history?

A: Shohei **Ohtani**

137. Diane Morgan plays the title character of what 2022 comedic mini series that follows her journey through the history of mankind?

A: ***Cunk on Earth***

138. Sacha Baron Cohen was threatened with legal action by what country's government in 2005 due to poor representation in one of his films?

A: Republic of **Kazakhstan**

139. The city of Lubeck was an important center in what merchant confederacy of Northern Europe?

A: **Hanseatic League**

140. Muhammad underwent a journey from Mecca to what city's Al-Aqsa in one night?

A: **Jerusalem**

141. "A man and his dad put a bomb in the sink" is a mnemonic for what theorem relating the lengths of a triangle's sides to that of its cevian?

A: **Stewart's** Theorem

142. Which American radio broadcaster is known for their Tiny Desk Concerts?

A: **NPR** (accept: **National Public Radio**)

143. Which German cake, thought to be named after its region of origin, is made by layering chocolate sponge cake with whipped cream and cherries?

A: **black forest** cake (accept: **schwarzwälder kirschtorte**)

144. Although he holds records in the 150 and 200m, what fittingly named sprinter is perhaps best known for his world record in the 100m dash?

A: Usain **Bolt**

143. A coil on a circuit diagram represents what circuit element that stores energy in a magnetic field?

A: **inductor**

144. What political acronym has been commonly used to describe people who support anti-trans sentiments under the guise of women's rights?

A: **TERF** (accept: **Trans Exclusionary Radical Feminist**)

145. What Greek letter's capital form is shaped like the capital "H" in English?

A: **eta**

146. Other than Switzerland, what is the only country without an official capital city, although it has a de facto one at Yaren?

A: Republic of **Nauru**

END OF GAME